

³Give us day by day our daily bread.

⁴Forgive us our sins, for we ourselves also forgive everyone who is indebted to us. Bring us not into temptation, but deliver us from the evil one.’ ”

The disciples watched Jesus pray and **wanted that**, not just a script.

Jesus gives them a pattern:

- Start with **who God is** (Father, holy, His Kingdom)
- Ask for **daily needs**
- Ask for **forgiveness** and help to forgive others
- Ask for help in **temptation**

Reflection Question

Which part of that prayer do you use most—praise, daily needs, forgiveness, or help in temptation? Which part do you usually skip?

Bite 2 – Don’t Quit Praying, Luke 18:1–5 (WEB)

¹ He also spoke a parable to them that they must always pray, and not give up, ² saying, “There was a judge in a certain city who didn’t fear God, and didn’t respect man. ³ A widow was in that city, and she often came to him, saying, ‘Defend me from my adversary!’

⁴ He wouldn’t for a while; but afterward he said to himself, ‘Though I neither fear God, nor respect man, ⁵ yet because this widow bothers me, I will defend her, or else she will wear me out by her continual coming.’

Jesus tells a story about a judge who doesn’t care about God or people. A widow keeps coming anyway, asking for justice. The judge finally responds—not because he’s good, but because she **doesn’t quit**.

Jesus uses this to show: if even a bad judge listens to persistence, how much more will a **good God** listen to His kids?

Reflection Question

Is there something you used to pray about that you've stopped praying for because it took too long?

Bite 3 – God Is Not Like the Unjust Judge, Luke 18:6–8 (WEB)

⁶The Lord said, “Listen to what the unrighteous judge says. ⁷Won’t God avenge his chosen ones, who are crying out to him day and night, and yet he exercises patience with them? ⁸I tell you that he will avenge them quickly. Nevertheless, when the Son of Man comes, will he find faith on the earth?”

Jesus makes the contrast clear:

- God is not like an unjust judge.
- God **hears** His people crying out day and night.
- The question isn’t “Will God answer?” It’s “Will we still have **faith** when He does?”

Reflection Question

What does it look like—for you—to “always pray and not give up” about one thing this week?

Dessert

Jesus’ life says:

- Prayer isn’t just something we do **when all else fails**.
- Prayer is how we **breathe with God**—daily, honestly, persistently.

Reflection Question

Finish this: “From now on, when I feel overwhelmed, I want to **pray first** instead of _____.”

To-Go Box

- If Jesus needed to pull away and pray, we definitely do too.
- Prayer is simple: talk to God, listen, and keep coming back.
- Not every prayer gets answered the way we expect—but **no prayer is ignored**.

Write one sentence:

“Jesus, help me remember to talk to You **before** I _____.”

Prayer

“Jesus, thank You for showing us what real prayer looks like. Forgive me for the times I only pray when I’m desperate. Help me to come to You first—not last. Teach me to pray simply, honestly, and consistently, and not to give up when I don’t see answers right away. In Your name, amen.”

Activity – “First Response Check” (Youth)

Fill in:

1. One thing that stresses me out: _____
2. My usual first response (be honest): _____
3. A new first response I want to try: **Pray before I** _____.

(Answers are personal; no key needed in the student book—only in your heart.)

BM1 – Lesson 4: Paul & Silas

Faith in the Dark

 **Theme:** Praising God when life feels unfair

 **Background Text:** Acts 16:16–34

 **Key Verse:** Acts 16:25 (WEB)

“But about midnight Paul and Silas were praying and singing hymns to God, and the prisoners were listening to them.”

 **Appetizer – Doing Right and Still Getting Hurt, Acts 16:22–24 (WEB)**

²² The multitude rose up together against them, and the magistrates tore their clothes off of them, and commanded them to be beaten with rods.²³ When they had laid many stripes on them, they threw them into prison, charging the jailer to keep them safely, ²⁴ who, having received such a command, threw them into the inner prison, and secured their feet in the stocks.

Paul and Silas helped set a slave girl free from a spirit that was controlling her.

Instead of getting a “thank you,” they were:

- Stripped
- Beaten
- Thrown into the **inner prison**
- Locked in stocks

They were in pain for doing the **right** thing.

 **Reflection Question**

How do you usually react when you get in trouble or get hurt for doing something right?

Main Course

Bite 1 – Midnight Praise, Acts 16:25 (WEB)

“But about midnight Paul and Silas were praying and singing hymns to God, and the prisoners were listening to them.”

At their worst moment—midnight, in pain, chained—they choose to:

- **Pray**
- **Sing hymns to God**

Everyone else is listening. Their worship turns the prison into a **sanctuary**.

Reflection Question

If someone listened to you in your “midnight moments,” what would they hear—complaints, silence, or praise?

Bite 2 – The Shaking, Acts 16:26–28 (WEB)

²⁶ Suddenly there was a great earthquake, so that the foundations of the prison were shaken; and immediately all the doors were opened and everyone’s bonds were loosened. ²⁷ The jailer, being awakened out of his sleep and seeing the prison doors open, drew his sword and was about to kill himself, supposing that the prisoners had escaped. ²⁸ But Paul cried with a loud voice, saying, “Don’t harm yourself, for we are all here!”

God answers in a wild way:

- Earthquake
- Open doors
- Loose chains

But the first miracle Paul and Silas walk in is **self-control**. They stay, not because they’re stuck, but because they see the jailer’s life is on the line.